

# Design system & navigation spec

Visual reference companion to HANDOFF .md. Locked decisions, tokens, type, table anatomy, and the IAM/Settings navigation model — as built in the reference prototype.

**Typeface** IBM Plex

**Header** Titled

**Chrome** Framed

**Density** Compact

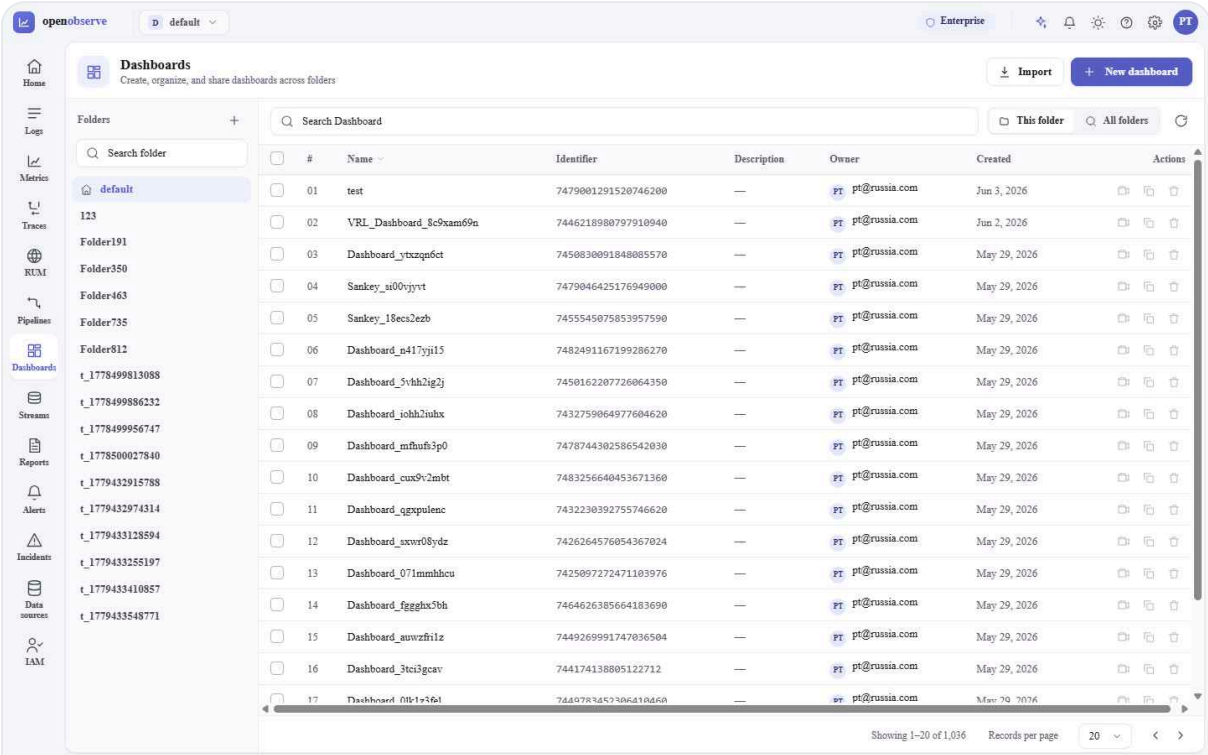
**Casing** Sentence

**Surface** Combined

Reference screens

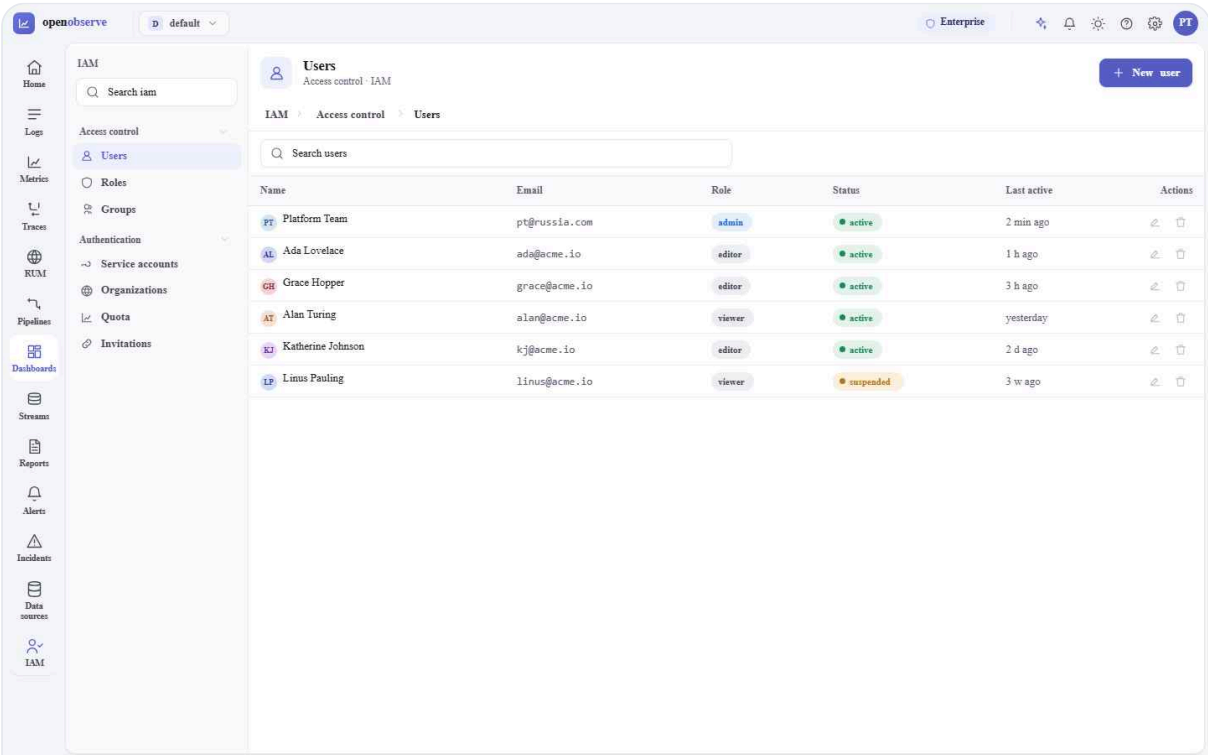
Visual references

Captured from the working prototype. Full interaction detail and exact CSS values live in HANDOFF .md.



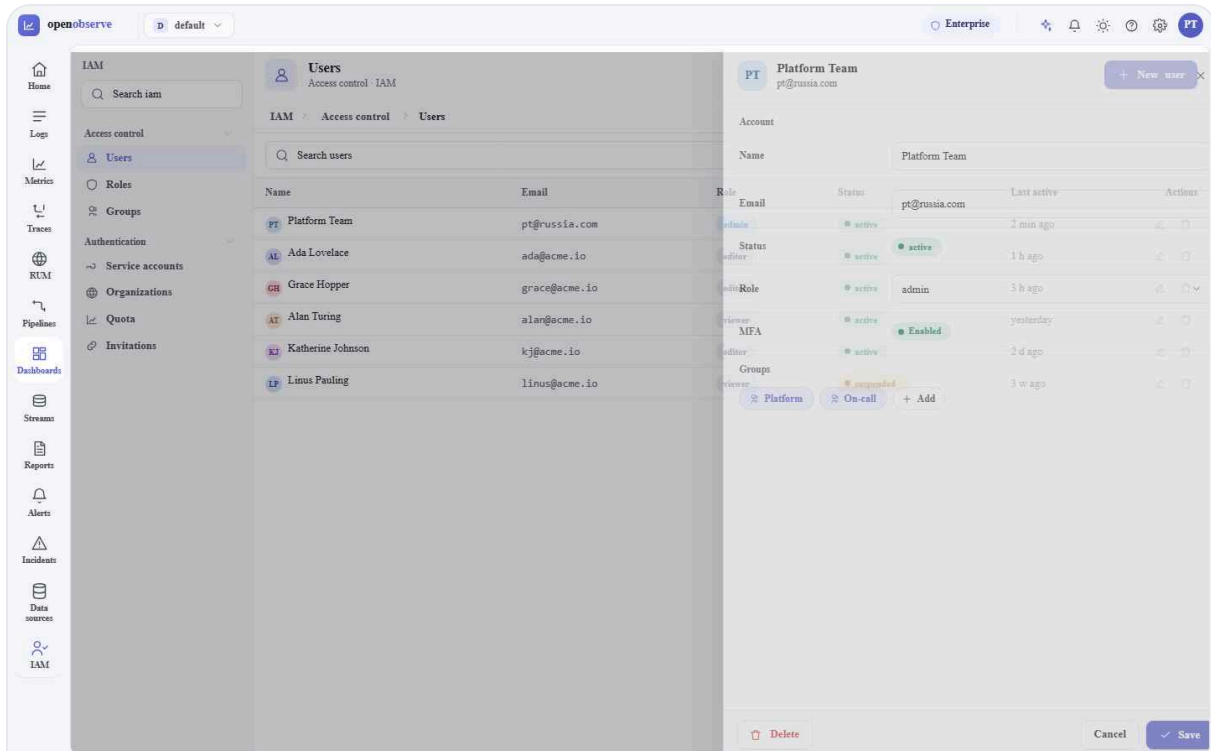
Flat list page — Dashboards

Framed chrome · titled header (tile + title + subtitle, tagline row 2) · in-content folder rail · data table with serial, fluid name column, and a minimal hover-revealed action column.



Admin module — IAM

Grouped left rail (6+ sections) → one header with breadcrumb IAM > Access control > Users → full-width table. Search-only toolbar; primary CTA top-right.



### Record editing — drawer

Row click (or “+ New”) opens a right-side drawer with key/value fields and a Delete · Cancel · Save footer. Edit in the context of the list — no full-page hop.

## Settings

### Settings — identical pattern

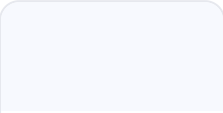
Settings reuses the exact IAM shell: grouped rail → table → drawer, breadcrumb Settings > Security > Cipher keys. The two modules are mechanically the same.

## Foundations

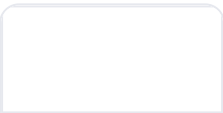
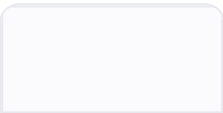
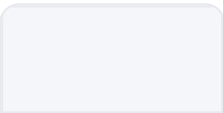
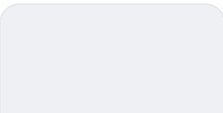
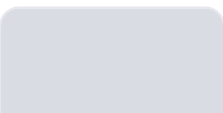
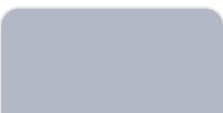
# Color tokens

Reference the semantic aliases in components — never a raw hex. The ramps below feed those aliases.

### Iris — brand / accent ramp

|                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <br><b>iris-200</b><br>#F7F9FE | <br><b>iris-300</b><br>#EFF1FD  | <br><b>iris-400</b><br>#E4E9FE  | <br><b>iris-500</b><br>#D7DEFE  | <br><b>iris-700</b><br>#B3BDF1 |
| <br><b>iris-900</b><br>#6B76E3 | <br><b>iris-1000</b><br>#6069D3 | <br><b>iris-1100</b><br>#575FC5 | <br><b>iris-1200</b><br>#282D5D |                                                                                                                   |

### Neutral — gray ramp

|                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <br><b>g-0</b><br>#FFFFFF    | <br><b>g-50</b><br>#FBFBFD   | <br><b>g-100</b><br>#F5F6F9  | <br><b>g-150</b><br>#EEF0F4  | <br><b>g-200</b><br>#E6E8EE  |
| <br><b>g-300</b><br>#DADCE4 | <br><b>g-400</b><br>#B4B8C4 | <br><b>g-600</b><br>#5C606E | <br><b>g-700</b><br>#474A56 | <br><b>g-900</b><br>#1B1D24 |

### Semantic — status

|                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                            |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <br><b>Primary</b><br>buttons · links     | <br><b>OK</b><br>healthy · active | <br><b>Warn</b><br>degraded · pending |
| <br><b>Danger</b><br>errors · destructive | <br><b>Info</b><br>informational  |                                                                                                                            |

**Token rules:** primary names → `--text` ; metadata / column heads / IDs / timestamps → `--text-3` . Outer & input borders → `--border` ; row & section dividers → `--border-soft` . Selected rows use `--iris-300` , never `--primary` at full strength. One primary action per view.

# Typography

IBM Plex Sans for UI · IBM Plex Mono for every identifier, count, timestamp and code string.

## The weight scale — weight signals hierarchy

|                                                                                    |                                                                                         |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>700</div> <div>Title peak</div> <div>One per view. Never 800.</div>           | <div>600</div> <div>Nav · buttons</div> <div>Active nav, buttons, badges, labels.</div> |
| <div>500</div> <div>Record names</div> <div>The name column. Calm, not loud.</div> | <div>400</div> <div>Body &amp; meta</div> <div>Body, metadata, IDs, captions.</div>     |

## Type scale (compact)

|                          |                                        |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Page title · 17/700      | Dashboards                             |
| Drawer title · 18/700    | Platform Team                          |
| Section label · 11.5/600 | Account                                |
| Body / cell · 13/400     | Create, organize and share dashboards. |
| Column head · 12/600     | Last active                            |
| Mono / ID · 13/400       | 7479001291520746200                    |

## Components

### Table anatomy

Fixed widths for bounded columns; one fluid name column absorbs slack. Sticky header, minimal action column.

| Column             | Width        | Rule                                                                                                                                                             |
|--------------------|--------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Checkbox           | 40px         | Fits the 16px box + padding. Header holds select-all.                                                                                                            |
| Serial #           | 48px         | Tabular-nums, <code>--text-3</code> , zero-padded. Flat lists only.                                                                                              |
| Name               | auto / fluid | The one column with no fixed width. 500 weight.                                                                                                                  |
| ID / hash          | fit content  | <code>.mono</code> , <code>--text-3</code> , sized to known length.                                                                                              |
| Enum (role/status) | ~96–120px    | Sized to the badge.                                                                                                                                              |
| Timestamp          | ~110–140px   | <code>--text-3</code> .                                                                                                                                          |
| Actions            | 90px, right  | Minimal. 1–3 icon verbs, <code>opacity .35</code> → <code>1</code> on row hover; overflow → <code>...</code> . Sticky-right when the table scrolls horizontally. |

**Deciding a width:** measure the widest realistic value at 13px, add 28px (2×14 padding), round up. Keep total fixed widths under the viewport so the fluid name column always has room; `.tbl-wrap{overflow:auto}` is the safety valve. Header is `position:sticky;top:0`; rows are 38px (compact).

## The one-header law & breadcrumbs



### One header per view

Row 1 = tile + title + subtitle + primary action. Row 2 = **exactly one** of {tabs · breadcrumb · tagline}.  
The header identifies the module and never mutates between tabs.



### Tabs vs rail

2–5 sibling sections → **tabs** in row 2. 6+ sections → **grouped left rail**. IAM (7) and Settings (16) both use the rail, so they behave identically.



### Breadcrumbs

Only on an L3+ drill, always in header row 2. Module > Group > Record. Crumbs back-navigate; collapse the middle to  past 4 levels (keep first + last two).



### Edit in a drawer

Admin records open in a right-side drawer (460 / 600px), Esc-dismiss, Delete · Cancel · Save footer. “+ New” opens the same drawer blank. Full-page only when the detail needs full width.